

SANJOY GHOSH

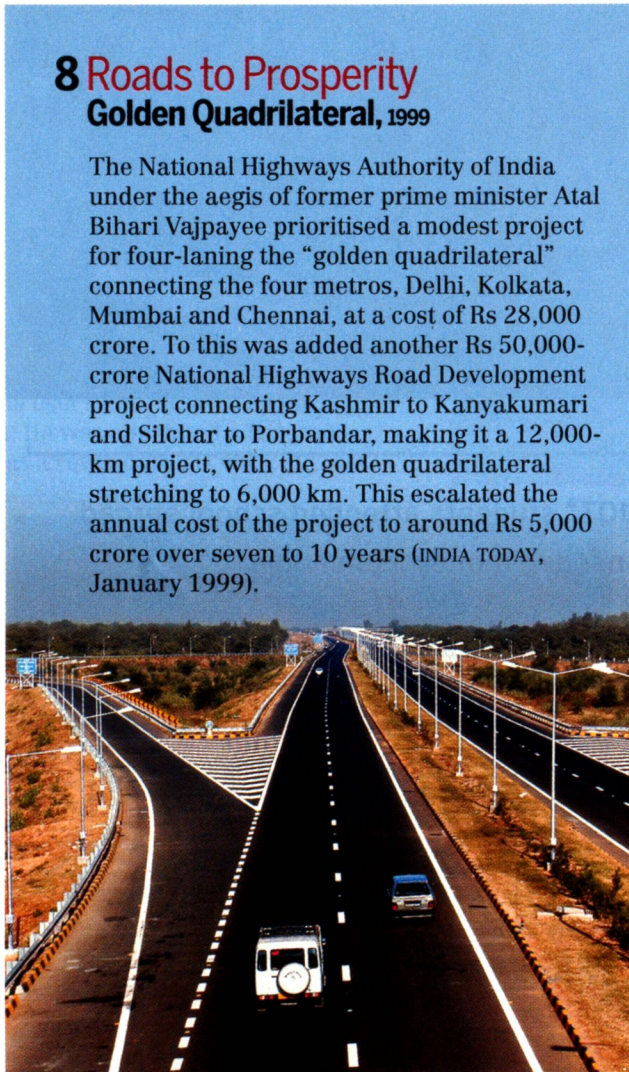


6 Net Gain Internet, 1995

The postman doesn't need to deliver mail anymore. Just key in your username and password and read and send mails to anyone, anywhere, noted INDIA TODAY in September 1995. By the end of 2008, India will boast of 49.4 million Net users, with one in five coming from rural areas, all of them waiting to explore the million possibilities available on the web (INDIA TODAY, December 2007).

7 Dream Run Metro, 1996

Cabinet clearance for a Rs 4,860-crore Mass Rapid Transit System for Delhi was the answer to the harried urban commuter's dream of speedy and economic travel, observed INDIA TODAY in October 1996. Delhi's first metro track, a mix of underground, surface and elevated corridors, became functional in 2002. Once fully operational, it would make 2,400 buses redundant, bring down pollution by half and allow a saving of Rs 500 crore per year in fuel costs (INDIA TODAY, December 2001). In 2006, the prime minister laid the foundation stones for metro rails in Mumbai and Bangalore (INDIA TODAY, December 2006).



SHAILESH RAVAL

8 Roads to Prosperity Golden Quadrilateral, 1999

The National Highways Authority of India under the aegis of former prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee prioritised a modest project for four-laning the "golden quadrilateral" connecting the four metros, Delhi, Kolkata, Mumbai and Chennai, at a cost of Rs 28,000 crore. To this was added another Rs 50,000-crore National Highways Road Development project connecting Kashmir to Kanyakumari and Silchar to Porbandar, making it a 12,000-km project, with the golden quadrilateral stretching to 6,000 km. This escalated the annual cost of the project to around Rs 5,000 crore over seven to 10 years (INDIA TODAY, January 1999).



RAVI S. SAHANI

9 Street Smart Gram Sadak Yojana, 2000

The NDA government launched a Rs 2,500-crore project for building 3,69,000 km of roads to link 1,70,000 habitations (INDIA TODAY, March 2001). But it was not just about providing "the last mile" near the village, but to forge the "farm-to-market" link (INDIA TODAY, April 2005). By 2007, over 1,11,000 km of roads had been built to connect 33,041 habitations.

K.M. KISHEN



10 Fast Track Railways, 2004-07

When Lalu Prasad stepped into Rail Bhavan in May 2004, the fear of a 'Biharification' of the railways was imminent. But he converted it into a cash-rich entity. In 2004-05, the earnings were Rs 1,883 crore over the target, earning a surplus of Rs 20,000 crore in 2007 (INDIA TODAY, September 2005).

by Purvi Malhotra